grievances heard, whether their party was in power or not. Citizens who come to them only expect a helping hand in trying to resolve their grievances, and at the very least that the party and its workers provide them a hearing and amplify their voices. That is the minimum that one would expect a citizen to demand after making an effort to reach and engage with a party-organized platform such as the BJY.

But let's come back to the process of democratic consultation that this Yatra gave birth to. In every state the consultation with civil society groups followed a slightly different pattern, and the conversations and their follow-ups were nuanced in different ways. Former civil servants Sasikanth Senthil and K. Raju played an important role in organizing these interactions in Karnataka and Telangana, respectively. However, in Rajasthan a civil society coordination group was requested to chalk out a daily programme through which a wide range of issues could be raised and affected people from marginalized communities could speak to Rahul Gandhi as well as the state leadership, since this was a state where the Congress party was in power.

Organizers from the Yatra continually reached out to the civil society group during this period and made a sincere effort to see that the programme chalked out was followed, and that if a particular scheduled interaction could not take place for some reason, an effort was made to work out an alternative space for the dialogue.

As a result, over the eighteen days of the Yatra in Rajasthan, multiple groups connected with the Yatra on issues, including women's groups, farmers' groups, nomadic communities, folk artist communities, youth, those working in the health and education sectors, the elderly and the disabled. A range of labour-related groups such as mine workers suffering from silicosis, domestic workers, street vendors, safai karamcharis and even the platform-based gig workers, whose periodic interactions with Rahul Gandhi have already been discussed, could get access to state their demands.